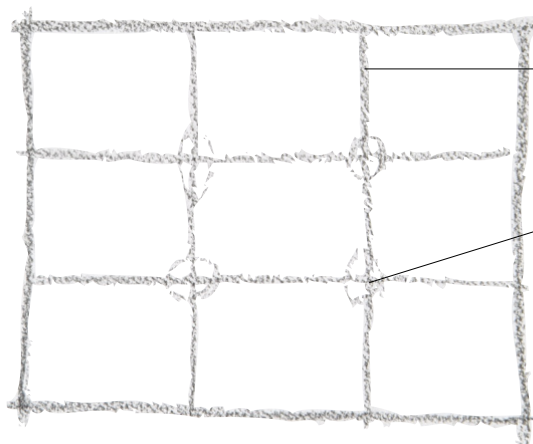


## USING THE RULE OF THIRDS

To help you plan your composition and give it visual impact, try using the rule of thirds. Divide your paper into thirds both vertically and horizontally to make a nine-box grid. At first you may want to draw these lines on the paper with a pencil, but with practice, the grid can be imaginary. For maximum effect, position the main elements of your design on the lines. Place the horizon line, for example, a third up from the bottom or a third down, and use the points where the lines intersect for your areas of interest.



Put objects on the vertical lines rather than in the center of the picture.

Put your focal point where two lines cross.

The focal point, the face, has been placed where two lines intersect.



**Girl in artist's studio** This painting of a figure in a clutter of objects and colors could have looked quite chaotic, but because the areas of interest have been placed according to the rule of thirds, the composition is well balanced and pleasing to the eye.

The lines of the chair draw the eye into an otherwise empty area.